

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Sreedhar Ravula

Address: 29 Prior Avenue Sutton SM2 5HY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to object to the proposed conversion of the former ambulance station into a religious centre. While I recognize the value of community facilities, the specific nature of this site and its location within a quiet residential area make this change of use inappropriate for the following reasons:

Impact on Residential Amenity (Noise and Disturbance): Unlike its previous use as an emergency service base (which had intermittent and predictable activity), a religious centre typically generates concentrated periods of high activity, often during evenings and weekends when residents expect quiet. The noise from large gatherings, arrivals/departures, and amplified sound would cause significant "noise nuisance" to the immediate neighbors.

Highways Safety and Parking Pressure: The surrounding residential streets are narrow and already experience high parking demand. A religious centre attracts a large number of visitors simultaneously. The current site does not appear to have sufficient off-street parking to accommodate a full congregation, which will lead to overspill parking on residential roads, blocking driveways and creating hazards for emergency access and pedestrians.

Change in Character of the Area: This is a quiet, established residential neighborhood. The intensification of use-transforming a low-occupancy service building into a high-capacity public assembly point-is a significant "material change of use" that is inconsistent with the tranquil character of the area defined in the Sutton Local Plan.

Inadequate Access: The access points designed for ambulance vehicles may not be safe for the high volume of pedestrian traffic, including families and children, that a community centre attracts, leading to potential road safety issues.

I request that the Planning Committee conducts a full Noise Impact Assessment and a Transport Statement before any decision is made, and I urge the Council to refuse this application to protect

the living conditions of the local residents.